

LETTER FROM HENRY
DUFFIELD TO HIS BROTHER
BETHUNE DUFFIELD IN MICHIGAN

Head Quarters 9th Reg^t Me⁹
Middletown December 13th 1861

My dear Shime

I received your letter containing
amount of my indebtedness and find it correct
as far as items are concerned but I did not
expect that you would advance for them all not-
do I wish you to do so for although it will
eventually be received by you still you will have
been for two months advancing some two hundred
or more dollars and it will not be until the
the first of March (owing to the way in which
we are paid) that I can all square with you
I understood rather that he was going to take up
some of the small debts and although I would
still have against me the same amount of
encumbrances it would be more easily earned
by my creditors if it was in some way a
little divided. Did you ^{father or mother} ask whether Phelps, Mudgett
and Town & Sheldon's Bill, had been paid? I will be
paid on January 1st ~~the~~ between 2⁰⁰ & 260 dollars but
my mess bill and the necessary money to have with
me will bring it down to less than \$240. I am
afraid. My pay is \$136.50 per month making from
the 1st of Nov^r to the 1st of January due me from
the 1st of Nov^r \$278.00 outside of this there is due me from
some body either the State of United States pay for six
days at 455 per day amounting to 2785 if I could get

that at the next payment and the Paymaster said
he had no doubt I would there would be due me

For pay from Nov: 1st to Jan: 1st 1900 278.21

For pay " Sept: 10 to 16th 27.86

Total 306.07

Deduct Thomas wages 26.00

" Mess Bill about 16.00

" Personal monies 20.00

Amount Remaining 244.07

If however I do not receive pay for the time between 27.86

Sept: 10 & 16 I will have but 226.21

this leaving me in your debt 43.84

I still have between ten and fifteen dollars of what you
gave me when I started and I do not think I shall
need to retain more than 15.00 or 20.00 dollars for my
own use. The only reason I have used up so much of
this is because as I settled down into camp life I found
out many little things would tend to my comfort which
I had not thought of before. I am sorry that you took up
all these debts as it is. I suppose a pretty hard time
for money and may give you trouble. The Mess Bill
from some cause or other has been ~~excessively~~ ^{excessively} high. ~~costing~~
from the 2nd of ~~September~~ ^{October} to the 24th of November \$50.50 or in
other words \$12.50 a week a pretty high price for board!

We have had a new arrival of another regiment which
has just arrived on the other side of Salt River but whether
they will remain here or go on to Elizabethtown I do not
know. One thing I do know however that we are going to

id
me
have a big fight down here in Kentucky seventeen Reg^{ts}
passed through Louisville day before yesterday for down
South and four Reg^{ts} passed through here making
21,000 mi all moving Southward as fast as possible
two more have passed here yesterday and day before
yesterday. In fact every soldier that Bull can command
he is pushing down and will probably make a
simultaneous attack ~~with~~ with Mc Clellan. I hope
he will succeed but our men are mostly sick or
heavily convalescent and I am a little afraid we
may get whipped. If we do the "gallant ninth" will
have a chance to distinguish themselves. We have a
strong position and our men are cool and steady
and will fight like heroes. I feel confident of that.
So you may expect that you will have cause
to rejoice in having two brothers in the 9th. If
you been with or my description of our Fort you
will see not only that it is very strong but also
that it has another very important advantage
namely that once in the Fort we must stay there
we can have no Bull Run here for the simple
reason that there is no opportunity for it. On one
side the enemy and on the other a precipice.
Then again our boys are just the men for the
place. They are cool and steady and although
I do not think they will ~~ever~~ do anything very
dashing or brilliant they will stay like Bull dogs.
If they ever have the opportunity they will show

H. M. Duffield
Dec 18/61

Their faces cool and determined, and so great is their confidence in their Colonel, we can hold them up to anything they will stand by him to the death. This is not mere "bragg". I saw it the night we first turned out at the long roll. They came out silently and quietly, while an Ohio Regiment was kicking a big enough rumpus for a whole army of rebels. I must close this in order to make out my report in time for the mail. I sincerely congratulate you on your new accession to the family. Give my respects to Mrs. Lathrop, Elisha and any of my friends who may enquire after me, and believe me

Your affectionate brother
Henry M. Duffield.

My Dear Thome

Your letters are received requesting to know what our sick folks need. I can safely answer that we are liberally supplied with everything we need, more that the kindness of the Military Board have given us the requisite stimulants we so much need. The ladies of our own state as well as the state of Ohio and Indiana have been very liberal also, and we are now in best late condition. Now that the Surgeon or doctor has returned we do not need the service of an assistant Surgeon as I have picked into the service Dr. Georgeagan a physician familiar with the disease of this locality and we have been steadily improving since he began. We are gaining rapidly in both health strength and spirit. I am quite encouraged once more. Our move upon the hill has been of great service to us. The absence of malaria incident to this high ground has checked the typhoid and by the first of January we will I am confident be all right. The men improve daily although we have buried thirty of our men before in Kentucky. I will try and get you a pass from that point although I cannot promise to succeed in the operation as I understand all passes to citizens are strictly prohibited. Yours in great haste H. M.

Headquarters 9th Regt
West Point Nov 11th 1861

General

Agreeably to your request I write of our
threats and condition

The measles have made sad havoc with us
and this has been aggravated by the severe labor
we have been compelled to perform in building roads
and constructing a field work upon Milledgeville
hill.

Our hospital contains over three hundred men
and I have taken possession of three houses, for the
use of hospital. The patients increase on our
hands, and I fear we may have to go through
with it before it stops. We are completely used
up as far as duty is concerned by the sick and
the details necessary for fatigue & guarding
stores and picket as you will perceive by the
following statement

tell them
that it is
not that

at the
of the
of the
of the
of the

Left for me
to the
of the
- no more
and -
and
the water
at the
but it was

Fatigue party building but

Police (old guard).

Pickett

Guarding stores ferry &c

2 companies on hill in charge of fort

Sent home sick

Lied

attendance on sick, cooks & nurses

Total off duty

Total, Present and absent

amount left

If you can spare us one hundred men by all means let us have them. If not authorize me to send an officer to recruit. We need a surgeon by all convenient speed. If Dr Powers cannot come, by all means send us another as we absolutely require him.

^{as}
~~into~~ the large number on the sick list will
satisfy you I trust.

Tomorrow the Indiana & Ohio Regiments start
for Elizabethtown and then we will be left
here alone in our glory, and our details will
of course be heavier.

I am somewhat discouraged at the turn
affairs have taken but trust that ^{as} it is al-
ways darkest before the day that we are
at the turning point, and will hereafter
continue to improve.

If we are indebted to the 8th Regt for our
measles I am very much obliged to them.

I will endeavor to keep you advised of
our condition. Fortunately our officers con-
tinue well, with the exception of Capt. Bonds,
who has returned on two months sick leave
and Sient Hornbeck laid up with intermit-
tent fever.

Yours in great haste

M. W. Duffield
Col. 9th Regt. in J.

Head Quarter West Point Brigade
Muldoon Hill Decm. 4th 1861

General

I am in receipt of your favors relative to Capt. Geo. A. Chase and Surgeon E. Church.

Dr Church has reported for service and is now at the Hospital at West Point.

Our sickness is on the decline on sick report of today showing two hundred and forty six (246) instead of three hundred and thirty two (332) of last week. The character of sickness is also improving, the typhoid symptoms being evidently on the decline.

Sgt James E. Fairbanks, whom you report as arrested claims not to have been mustered into the United States Service.

Captain Miller claims that he was, although all the other Sergeants say he was not. At all events his name is not borne upon the Muster Roll for payment made by Captain Miller dated November 30th 1861. Whether he is borne on the original Muster in roll I cannot state as I have never received these rolls from Captain Henry R. King, although he states they were forwarded by express.

Captain Miller's company E is in a terrible state. There has been a personal quarrel between the captain and Sergeant Shain, which has at last culminated in an arrest of Shain upon charges preferred by Captain Miller, and the arrest of Miller upon charges preferred by Shain. I have forwarded both charges to Department Head Quarters and recommended that as both officers were inefficient, and not worthy the time of the officers necessary for a general

not material that a commission be approved and that they be both examined with a view to their discharge

The company is thoroughly demoralized by this personal quarrel and can only be brought into good discipline by the loss of both these officers

I am busily occupied getting the men in comfortable log cabins and trust they will all be housed by the close of this week.

Through the blunder of Company E's Muster Roll I have been through back so as to draw pay from the 20th September instead of the 10th and this carries the entire staff into it.

Nearly all the officers are minus pay in consequence of the new order which will not allow company officers to draw pay until they have mustered the minimum number of sixty four privates. The Colonel and staff until the companies are all full up to minimum number notwithstanding General Orders No 44 and 61.

I am formally assigned to the command of this post and the field work with seven pieces on the hill. This gives me the duties of Brigadier upon the pay of Colonel. This post is the magazine of supplies and military stores for all the troops in our front, and in addition to the care of my own Regiment keeps me constantly employed and this must be my apology for not writing you more at length than I otherwise should

I am much aided by Lieut Colonel Parkhurst, who is a most-able and valuable officer. He is working very hard and as he is a person of known and tried courage

I have every reason to believe that he will soon become as valuable an officer as the State has in her service.

I enclose copy of order assigning me to the command of this Post.

The weather is severe for this locality, the thermometer last night was five degrees below zero and we have now six inches of snow upon the ground. I am glad to see this as I trust it will have a tendency to stop the prevalence of Typhoid which has decimated our ranks.

Our mortality thus far has been nineteen privates and ten non-commissioned officers. I trust that by New Year's day we will be upon our feet hale and hearty. With few exceptions our officers continue well and apt-Surgeon Smith has been both constant in his labor and skilful in his treatment of disease. His untiring efforts entitle him to great praise.

I remain

General

Brig. General John Robinson

adjutant General, State of Michigan
Detroit

Yours obedient Servant

Wm. W. Dubfield

Col. 9th Regt. Mich. Infy

Commandg Brigade

Adjutant
Henry M. Duffield

Oct 3, 1861

Adjutant Henry M. Duffield

I give you this sword my
dear boy to defend our beloved
Government & the Union one & un-
divided dear to my heart as it
has always been -

Remember you bear no trifling
brand - for

"Honors bright hilt is in your hand
Go! for your Flag undaunted stand -"

"Heavens blessing upon it! its stars
~~shone~~ ^{shone} yes

With a lustre so pure and so warm
like a beacons ~~calm~~ ^{calm} light pointing
out the safe way

They gleam thro' the gathering storm
Their heart cheering light led on ^{right} fathers

Thro' all the dark perils they knew;

The same magic glow shall lead you to the foe
And guide you to victory too -"

I give to my Country two bright
gems from the cluster of my Home

1/1
Geo W. Crook

Camp Duffield

Nov 2nd 1861

9-9th Regt

Camp Duffield
Nov 2 1861.

To Col William W Duffield
9th Regiment
Michigan Infantry

Dear Sir

At Fort Wayne
in the month of October Lt Mortimer Mansfield
& Lt William A. Hull & myself with an equal
number of men consolidated our companies
they taking the positions of 1st & 2^d Lieutenants
giving me Captain. My position being a
very responsible one I have done all in my
power to fill it with honor having very little
time as yet to perfect myself in the tactics
but intend to use every means in my power
to do so at the same time see that my men
are as well taken care of as they can be which
I have tried to do heretofore. Since the
consolidation of my company ^{the said} Lt Mansfield
& Lt Hull assisted by their former orderly sergeant

I & Sargeant have endeavored to create
a dissatisfaction with the men against me as Captain
so as to have they themselves promoted Lt Mansfield
as Captain. Lt Hull & Lt & Co. on they have not
assisted me in my duty as they should have
done nor as their position required. On the
31st day of October my orderly Sargeant received
order to make out a muster roll for the pay
of the men which I had him do immediately after
receiving the order, after he had finished it
with the exception of filling out the heading &
my Certifying to the same. I examined the roll
& ordered him to fill it up & I would Certify
to it. he said he was ordered not to fill it
up nor to Certify to the roll till after the inspection
which was a mistake of his as the Col said that
I ought to have certified to the roll & Certified
to the roll next morning. Lt Mansfield, hearing
that I had not Certified to the roll started for
the camp & told the men that they would
not get their pay and that it was my fault.
they now think that ^{they} will not get their pay which
creates dissatisfaction the trouble is among the

men that existed with Lt Mansfield
& Hull who want Lt Mansfield for this
Captain. Every man has been used to
influence all of my men against me.
I have the honor to be with respect

Your Obedient Servant -

Geo. W. Chase
Capt Company G. 9th Regiment
Michigan Infantry

I wrote July 21. 1862
Col. W. W. Duffield
My dear son

I have been in
constant yearning to hear
some particulars in rela-
tion to your capture -
greatly rejoiced & Thank-
ful to our gracious God
that your life has been
preserved. You have
my constant sympathy & prayer. How-
ever there may be
disappointment &
wound yet in the
tribunal of judgment
we may say of them
ye. How I long to
feel & know that
you can look on
it in the light of
faith & rest in the
sweet assurance in

severest trials that all
things work together for
good to them that love God.
I wrote to your Henry
this p.m. Sunday of
Nashville in hope that
he might know where
you might be. The coun-
try is in the heat of a
awful crisis of spiritism.
We cannot give up the
contest. War in earnest
& with double forces
must take the place of
the kind of conciliating
warfare of late too
much relied upon for
conciliating those who
are actuated by what they
think a holy zeal in who
by no means care any thing for
honorably & humanely. The
Lord bless & keep you.

Willa
"is"

Give my love to
 Mary Kiss the
 little ones and
 tell me how
 you are getting on
 (Henry)

Dear Home

plus-jour nous appren-

But barely covered what I wanted when we joined in the

advance of the army here, reaching here the morning of Monday the 5th
mist and entering the city among the first regiments.

Since then I have been very busy getting up the regimental
papers and books which had not only been lost at the fight here in July last
but had also never been properly kept since I left the regiment in March
last, and I found letters from Gen^l. Robertson of Michigan and Gen^l. Thomas
at Washington stating that no such returns for this regiment had been
received since March 1862. It has kept me hard at work and in
addition thereto I have been appointed by Gen^l. Thomas as a Inspector
Gen^l. which adds to my duties considerably. The regiment did good
service here during the fight although not under any heavy fire
by checking a ~~panic~~^{panic} which would otherwise have spread through the
entire night ring of our army, and for their behavior were highly
complimented by Gen^l. Thomas' Chief of Staff and by the General
himself. There is no reason that I see why we should not now do
well if the officers would do their duty. But I am sorry to say
that there is not the zeal manifested by them that the circumstances
demand. Parkhurst could be one of the most efficient commanding
officers we could desire, indeed I think he will be anywhere but
here, but the besetting sin seems to have taken hold of him
again and not a night passes that finds him in camp. He
and our acting Major Captain Rounds are gone every night
and good old Major Milburne, who thinks I am a model
soldier and an oracle on military matters, comes in regularly
and says, "Well Adjutant you and I have got the regiment to run again
tonight I guess they had better let us run it altogether." This course
necessarily produces great dissatisfaction among the subordinate
officers especially those who were here in July last and saw the
evil consequences. Nor can I blame them. To tell the truth I cannot

sleep easy until I have personally gone the rounds of the guards
and ascertained that they are at their posts. It may be for Col
Anklam to act this way but for Rounds a married man and one who
was hopes, and is striving for promotion it is the very worst course to take
the officers have lost all respect for him and he has shown himself
terribly ignorant of his duties. At the time of the stampede Wednesday
morning the Colonel had to send me to the left of the line to form
the men into shape. He (Rounds) had thrown out no guides and being
muddled up like sheep with no formation whatever were in imminent
danger of being ordered over by the the frightened fugitives and sharing in the
panic. Another cause of discontent is the promotions that have been and
are being made in the regiment. When I returned to the regiment I saw
that there would be trouble on this score and having declined long
ago a captaincy and feeling that the only objection to my filling even
a higher position, if any objection existed, was my youth, added to the
fact that there was much work to be done in the Adjutant's office
before the regiment was in running order, ^{and no one competent to do it,} I declined the recommendation
offered by Major Wilkinson, who very kindly so stated in his letter to the
Governor. Lieut's Barrows (S.S.) & Moore being the poorest fitted for and
deserving of promotion have been commissioned as Captains thus
jumping Lieut's Higgins, Conley, Wright, Puddy & Barrow (Hiland)
who are among the best officers we have. Moore's commission
the Colonel has withheld and written relative thereto to the
Governor but Barrows brought his with him and is a fixture
The consequence you can readily imagine, one does not fancy after
seventeen months hard service to be cut out of his promotion, which a
soldier most desires, by a junior and a poorer officer and it has
caused great discontent.

But to look at the bright side of the picture, the "7th"

ms/ Duffield (S.P.)
1863, Jan. 19

has gained great credit for her part in the recent advance upon
and battle at, Appomattox, she is well known at Nashville as the
Regiment that checked the stampede and has negotiated her
into the favor of Genl. Thomas who rumor says is going to have
command here vice Rosecrans who will go to the Potomac
The men are in good health and spirits needing drill somewhat
but in excellent discipline Thomas comes over to see us often and
even went so far as to go out himself personally and pick
a camp for us the Friday we were coming from Nashville
His Inspector Genl. offered me in behalf of the General a place
on his staff but I had rather tired of "acting" appointments after
eight-months experience, and the Major was very unwilling for
me to leave the 9th, so I accepted the duties of a Inspector Genl.
but still hold my place with the Regiment and claim some of
the honors & privileges. It makes a little more work for me
but I fancy that all the better. Works drives away care and
keeps off the blues. I am sorry to be compelled to report Major McKim
quite sick and we sent him over to Major McCreary this morning
The Doctor says he don't think he will be sick long but I am a little
fearful for him. His short illness of two or three days has pulled him
down a great deal. We are having very much weather but plenty of
rain and mud. Almost all your acquaintances in fact all except
Major McCreary have joined the rebel service. The country is stripped of
inhabitants and everything else you could not know it. I wrote
Father to mule "Pet" at home or in Adair. I don't want to sell him
but want him here as soon as an opportunity occurs. He can be
muled for four or six dollars a month in the country, George
could find a place for him by inquiring of Mr. Rice the man
who keeps Pete, I mean by muling to let him run loose in
a field with mule environment and a stick to run into. Get him